members of the Bavadra cabinet/ said Taylor.

Over the next few days, as Kailash met ARC on several occasions, Malik found himself faced with possible exposure. He had taken on one of the most difficult tasks—shipping weapons and money to a group of Indians in Fiji to help them protect themselves against continuing atrocities by Rabuka's soldiers. His well-placed network in Australia was ready to ship a consignment of small arms into Fiji but a leaking cell ruined the plan. Australian enforcement authorities were tipped off about the cargo and on 10 June 19 8 8, an Australian newspaper suggested that India was involved in smuggling arms to Rabuka's opponents in Fiji.

The MEA had been dead against such an adventure against Rabuka, but was forced to issue a clarification denying India's role in the arms case:

Our attention has been drawn to a report in the Australian' alleging that India was heavily involved in recent moves towards a coup in Fiji and that arms recently seized by the Australian authorities at Sydney were sent by India. We take this opportunity of categorically denying this report as baseless, mischievous and motivated. It appears to us that strenuous efforts are being made by some to spread disinformation. The acting High Commissioner of Australia in India has been informed of our concern in the matter.

The person who leaked the information turned out to be a double agent, said Shekhawat, and he was eliminated before more harm could be done. 'But within days a paranoid Rabuka came out with a new rule presented as an internal security decree. Basically, it aimed to terrorise Indians by arresting without a court warrant anyone in possession of arms. It gave